



DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE

SUMMIT 2026

AGENDA

October 15–16
Arlington, VA
#DFIRSummit



DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Thursday, October 15

#DFIRSummit

View the complete agenda **here**.

8:00–9:00 AM ET	**Breakfast & Credential Pick Up** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)	
8:00–9:00 AM ET	**Solutions Expo** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)	
8:45–9:00 AM ET	In-Person Only – Location: Grand Ballroom ***Opening Remarks*** Ovie Carroll, Principal Instructor at SANS Institute; Director at DOJ Cybercrime Lab Mari DeGrazia, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute Ryan Chapman, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute; Team Lead, Managed Threat Hunting at Palo Alto Networks	
9:00–9:35 AM ET	KEYNOTE | ***Anti-Forensics in the Idaho Murders Case: The Traces He Left Trying to Leave No Trace*** Heather Barnhart, DFIR Curriculum Lead and Head of Faculty at SANS Institute	
9:35–10:10 AM ET	KEYNOTE | ***From Lilith to Truth: The Digital Evidence that Put the Badge Behind the Keyboard*** Jason Higley, Founder and Principal at SG Consulting	
10:10–10:30 AM ET	***In Conversation: Heather Barnhart and Jason Higley*** Heather Barnhart, DFIR Curriculum Lead and Head of Faculty at SANS Institute Jason Higley, Founder and Principal at SG Consulting	
10:30–10:45 AM ET	**Break and Track Transition** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)	
10:45–10:50 AM ET	DFIR Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Grand Ballroom ***Opening Remarks for Virtual Audience*** Ovie Carroll, Principal Instructor at SANS Institute; Director at DOJ Cybercrime Lab Mari DeGrazia, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute	Ransomware Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Potomac AB ***Opening Remarks for Virtual Audience*** Ryan Chapman, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute; Team Lead, Managed Threat Hunting at Palo Alto Networks
10:50–11:15 AM ET	***When Google Sends the Phish: Abusing Legitimate Infrastructure and Sender Identity in a Live Vishing Attack*** Dr. Mahesh Kalappattil, Senior Principal Engineer at Palo Alto Networks	***Stopping Ransomware Before Encryption – Threat Hunting Lessons from a Real-World Identity Attack*** Bryson Byrd, Cybersecurity Advisor at Huntress
11:15–11:40 AM ET	***OneDrive — Let's Take This Offline*** Brian Maloney, Lead IT Security Analyst at Thrivent Financial	***Unpatched, Unsegmented, Unprepared: A Ransomware Recovery Insight*** Javid Bakhtiani, Incident and Response Recovery Engineer at Rethinking Consulting Services (RTCS) Sarah Bukhari, President at Rethinking Consulting Services (RTCS)
11:40 AM–12:05 PM ET	***Who Put Holes in my Cheese: The Swiss Cheese Model of Root Cause Analysis*** Gerard Johansen, Principal at IR Proactive	***Breathes and Shuffles: Exposing Heuristic Blindspots in EDR Ransomware Detection Engines*** Michał Sołtysik, Cybersecurity Consultant at Michał Sołtysik CyberWave
12:05–12:30 PM ET	***From Drained Wallet to Threat Actor: A DFIR Investigation into ClickFix and Odyssey Stealer*** Aidan Holland, Senior Security Researcher at Censys	***Proving What Left the Building: Reconstructing Rclone Exfiltration from Memory Evidence*** Jason Trapp, Assistant Manager at McGrathNicol

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Thursday, October 15 *(continued)*

#DFIRSummit

View the complete agenda **here**.

12:30–1:20 PM ET — **Lunch and Solutions Expo** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)

1:20–1:45 PM ET

DFIR Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Grand Ballroom

Evidence Isn't on Disk: A DFIR Playbook for Compromised MCP Servers and AI Coding Agents

Samuel Addington, AI Researcher and Professor at California State University Long Beach

Christopher Earl, California State University San Bernardino

1:45–2:10 PM ET

From Alert to Intent: Investigating Insider Data Exfiltration Across USB, Email, and Cloud in Enterprise DFIR

Justin Price, Director of Threat Detection and Response at Johnson & Johnson

Rakesh Kumar Narsingoju, Lead Managed Services Engineer at Deloitte

2:10–2:40 PM ET

Squidoor – Dissecting a Sophisticated Multi-Platform Malware Used by a Chinese APT

Tom Fakterman, Senior Threat Researcher at Palo Alto Networks

Lior Rochberger, Principal Threat Researcher at Palo Alto Networks

2:40–3:00 PM ET — **Break and Transition to Workshops** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)

In-Person – Location: Grand Ballroom

3:00–5:00 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Operation Phantom Thread: Tracing the Attacker from First Foothold to Final Exfil**

Carlos Cajigas, Chief Technology Officer at Covert Bit

In-Person – Location: Potomac AB

3:00–5:00 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Threat Hunting and Criminal Infrastructure Analysis**

Conan Beach, Special Agent at U.S. Government

In-Person – Location: Georgetown

1:20–5:40 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Finding Answers Fast – Extracting Knowledge From the Noise**

Kevin Ripa, President at The Grayson Group of Companies

5:30–7:30 PM ET — **Summit Social** (Location: Continental Pool Lounge | 1911 Fort Myer Drive | Arlington, VA 22209)
After a full day of DFIR insights, join us at the SANS FIND EVIL Evening Social, hosted at the Continental Pool Lounge. Enjoy FIND EVIL-themed drinks and food, play pool, table tennis, shuffleboard, darts, or classic arcade games, all while connecting with fellow attendees, speakers, and SANS experts.

Summit CPEs & Certificate of Completion

In-Person attendees will receive up to 12 CPEs for attending SANS DFIR Summit 2026 live. Live Online attendees will receive 10 CPEs for attending SANS DFIR Summit 2026 live. Currently, we are not able to issue CPEs to those that view the Summit recordings. A Certificate of Completion will be available in your account after Friday, October 23 and can be found in the "Other Order(s) and Access Certificate(s) of Completion link" in the "My Orders" section of your SANS Dashboard Account. SANS will automatically submit your Summit CPEs to GIAC within 7–10 business days after the event's end date, no action is required on your part.

Slack

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Thursday, October 15

#DFIRSummit

DFIR SOLUTIONS TRACK AGENDA *(VIRTUAL)*

View the complete agenda **here**.

10:00–10:15 AM ET ***Opening Remarks***

Megan Roddie-Fonseca, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute; Senior Security Engineer at Datadog

10:15–10:45 AM ET ***From Alert to Evidence: Event-Driven Collections for Faster DFIR Investigations***

Jeff Rutherford, Forensic Consultant at Magnet Forensics

10:45–11:15 AM ET ***Execution-Level Analysis of a Russian-Speaking Multi-Operator Intrusion Campaign: Operation STANDOFF***

Hasan Mevzi, Cyber Threat Intelligence Analyst at VMRay

11:15–11:45 AM ET ***Agentic Workflows in Practice: Architecting Multi-Agent Investigations in a Production SOC***

Jamie Moles, Head of Technical Marketing at Extrahop

11:45 AM–12:00 PM ET **Break**

12:00–12:30 PM ET ***Watching the Watcher: Catching FalconFlank Where EDR Can't Look***

Jon Nelson, FIeld Solutions Architect at Leap

12:30–1:00 PM ET ***From Signal to Story: How Agentic AI Is Reshaping Incident Response***

Dave Gold, VP, Global Field CTO/CISO at SentinelOne

1:00–1:15 PM ET ***Closing Remarks***

Megan Roddie-Fonseca, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute; Senior Security Engineer at Datadog

Solutions Track CPEs & Certificate of Completion

You will receive 3 CPEs for attending SANS DIFR Solutions Track on October 15. A Certificate of Completion will be available in your account after the conclusion of the Solutions Track and can be found under the *My Webcasts* section of your SANS Dashboard Account. You will need to submit your certificate of completion to GIAC to receive your CPEs.

Slack

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Friday, October 16

#DFIRSummit

View the complete agenda here.

8:00–9:00 AM ET	**Breakfast and Solutions Expo** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)	
9:00–9:10 AM ET	In-Person & Streaming Virtually – Location: Grand Ballroom ***Opening Remarks*** Ovie Carroll, Principal Instructor at SANS Institute; Director at DOJ Cybercrime Lab Mari DeGrazia, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute Ryan Chapman, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute; Team Lead, Managed Threat Hunting at Palo Alto Networks	
9:10–9:45 AM ET	KEYNOTE | ***The AI System Was the Victim: Forensics for a Crime Scene With No Disk Image*** Raymond DePalma, President at DePalma Research LLC	
9:50–10:25 AM ET	***Rogue VM Chronicles: Forensic Reconstruction of a Scattered Spider Intrusion*** Cuong Dinh, Consulting Director at Palo Alto Networks – Unit 42 Justin De Luna, Senior Consultant at Palo Alto Networks – Unit 42	
10:25–10:45 AM ET	**Break and Track Transition** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)	
10:45–11:10 AM ET	DFIR Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer ***Tracing AI-Assisted IDEs: Forensic Artifacts, Agent Observability, and Software Supply Chain Risk*** Ashwin Patil, Principal Security Researcher at Microsoft	Threat Hunting Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Potomac AB ***How North Korea Pays its Bills by Creating a Human Botnet*** Jenn Gile, Co-Founder at OpenSourceMalware
11:10–11:35 AM ET	***Lost in the Logs: Navigating the Binary Format of the Apple-Unified Log*** Alexander Holcomb, Principal Consultant at Mandiant | Google Cloud	***Hunting OAuth Token Theft: Detecting Modern Identity Attacks Before They Become Breaches*** Bhaumik Shah, Founder and Chief Security Consultant at SecurifyAI Sarah Bukhari, President at Rethinking Consulting Services (RTCS)
11:35 AM–12:00 PM ET	***From Social Engineering to Asset Recovery: A Real-World Cross-Border Investigation into Cryptocurrency Theft*** Abdalla Jamal Alshamsi, Detective Officer at Sharjah Police Ahmed Belhay, First Lieutenant at Sharjah Police	***The Last Mile of Threat Hunting: Using LLM Agents to Execute and Refine Hunts at Scale*** Luis Garcia, Senior Security Engineer at Daylight Security

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Friday, October 16 *(continued)*

#DFIRSummit

View the complete agenda **here**.

12:00–12:50 PM ET

DFIR Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Grand Ballroom

DEBATE | ***The AI Question: What Does It Mean for DFIR?***

Heather Barnhart, DFIR Curriculum Lead and Head of Faculty at SANS Institute

Ovie Carroll, Principal Instructor at SANS Institute; Director at DOJ Cybercrime Lab

Mari DeGrazia, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute

Raymond DePalma, President at DePalma Research LLC

Threat Hunting Track: In-Person & Virtual – Location: Potomac AB

12:00–12:25 PM ET

Confidently Wrong: Feedback Loops of False Positives in AI-Augmented Threat Hunting

Molly Correia, Security Engineer Consultant at Con Edison

12:25–12:50 PM ET

When 100% Coverage Isn't Enough: Measuring Effective Detection Coverage

Antonia Feffer, Senior Cybersecurity Engineer at The MITRE Corporation

12:50–2:00 PM ET **Lunch and Solutions Expo** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)

In-Person – Location: Georgetown

2:00–4:00 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Protocol-SIFT and Linux Investigations: Speeding Things Up and Validating Results**

Jim Clausing, Technical Consultant, Network Security Architect at AT&T

In-Person – Location: Grand Ballroom

2:00–4:00 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Malicious Script Analysis for Ransomware Response**

Ryan Chapman, Team Lead, Managed Threat Hunting at Palo Alto Networks

In-Person – Location: Potomac AB

2:00–4:00 PM ET

WORKSHOP | **Know Normal, Catch Abnormal: Hands-On Baseline Hunting**

David Bianco, Certified Instructor at SANS Institute

Sydney Marrone, Head of Threat Hunting at Nebulock

3:00–3:20 PM ET **Break** (Location: Grand Ballroom Foyer)

Summit CPEs & Certificate of Completion

In-Person attendees will receive up to 12 CPEs for attending SANS DFIR Summit 2026 live. Live Online attendees will receive 10 CPEs for attending SANS DFIR Summit 2026 live. Currently, we are not able to issue CPEs to those that view the Summit recordings. A Certificate of Completion will be available in your account after Friday, October 23 and can be found in the "Other Order(s) and Access Certificate(s) of Completion link" in the "My Orders" section of your SANS Dashboard Account. SANS will automatically submit your Summit CPEs to GIAC within 7–10 business days after the event's end date, no action is required on your part.

Slack

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

Friday, October 16

#DFIRSummit

RANSOMWARE SOLUTIONS TRACK AGENDA *(VIRTUAL)*

View the complete agenda **here**.

10:00–10:15 AM ET ***Opening Remarks***

Sean O'Connor, Certified Instructor Candidate; Director at the Digital Defense Center at Southern Company

10:15–10:45 AM ET ***Outmatched: How Ransomware Evades Your EDR and Backups***

Tony Spinelli, Chief Security Officer at Halcyon

10:45–11:15 AM ET ***Defining the AI Frontier: Managing Data Integrity and Access in Decentralized Environments***

Marc Lueck, CISO-in-Residence at Zscaler

11:15–11:45 AM ET ***From Foothold to Full Encryption: Severing the Attack Paths Ransomware Depends On***

Adam Brown, Senior Attack Engineer at Horizon3

11:45 AM–12:00 PM ET **Break**

12:00–12:30 PM ET ***Session Sponsored by ESET***

12:30–12:45 PM ET ***Responding to Sophisticated Ransom Attacks in the Cloud***

Yotam Meitar, Director, Cloud Detection & Response at Wiz

12:45–1:00 PM ET ***Closing Remarks***

Sean O'Connor, Certified Instructor Candidate; Director at the Digital Defense Center at Southern Company

Solutions Track CPEs & Certificate of Completion

You will receive 3 CPEs for attending SANS Ransomware Solutions Track on October 16. A Certificate of Completion will be available in your account after the conclusion of the Solutions Track and can be found under the *My Webcasts* section of your SANS Dashboard Account. You will need to submit your certificate of completion to GIAC to receive your CPEs.

Slack

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

#DFIRSummit

So many Slack channels, so little time!

A quick guide on the channels you see and how to use them to make your Summit experience even better:

#0-help → Technical difficulties or issues accessing the event? Drop your questions here.

#01-announcements → Stay in the know about the latest Summit related announcements by joining this channel

#1a-track1-summit-discussion → Chat with fellow attendees, speakers, etc. from track 1 in this channel

#1b-questions-for-speakers-track-1 → Drop your questions here for our Summit speakers from track 1

#2a-track2-summit-discussion → Chat with fellow attendees, speakers, etc.from track 2 in this channel

#2b-questions-for-speakers-track-2 → Drop your questions here for our Summit speakers from track 2

#3a-solutions-track-discussion → Tuning in for our Summit Solutions Track? Chat with fellow attendees, speakers, etc. in this channel

#3b-questions-for-solutions-speakers → Drop your questions here for our Summit Solutions Track speakers

#4-graphic-recordings → Follow along as the fabulous Ashton creates amazing live graphic recordings for each of our Summit presentations

#5-new-to-cyber → If you're new to the industry, please feel free to visit this channel to connect with fellow newbies and build new connections

#6-pet-lovers → Take a brain break! Browse this channel to increase your serotonin and share pictures of your favorite furry friends

#7-business-card-swap → Share your LinkedIn or X handles to increase your professional network and build new relationships with like minded individuals

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

#DFIRSummit

THANK YOU TO OUR SPONSORS

DFIR PLATINUM VIRTUAL

EXTRAHOP

Symantec. by Broadcom

Carbon Black. by Broadcom

LEAP PLATFORM

SentinelOne

DFIR PLATINUM WITH TABLETOP

MAGNET FORENSICS®

VMRAY

DFIR SILVER

WIZ

censys

RANSOMWARE PLATINUM VIRTUAL

eset

halcyon

HORIZON3

WIZ

zscaler™

RANSOMWARE SILVER

SentinelOne

TABLETOP ONLY

Atola TECHNOLOGY

censys

compelson Makers of MOBILedit

evoke SECURITY

iVerify.

OSForensics Digital investigation for a new era

SPACEWALK

THREATLOCKER®

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE SUMMIT 2026

#DFIRSummit

EVALS

Day 1 – DFIR Track

Day 1 – Ransomware Track

Day 1 – Workshops

Day 2 – DFIR Track

Day 2 – Threat Hunting Track

Day 2 – Workshops





NOTES

Upcoming SANS Summits

2026

AI Cybersecurity Fall
Arlington, VA & Virtual
SUMMIT: November 2–3

2027

Cyber Threat Intelligence
Alexandria, VA
SUMMIT: February 1–2
TRAINING: February 3–8

Security Awareness & Culture
Denver, CO & Virtual
SUMMIT: July 29–30
TRAINING: July 26–28

OSINT
Alexandria, VA
SUMMIT: February 1–2
TRAINING: February 3–8

DFIR
Washington, DC
SUMMIT: August 23–24
TRAINING: August 25–30

AI Cybersecurity Spring
Denver, CO
SUMMIT: April 27–28
TRAINING: April 21–26

AI Cybersecurity Summit Fall
Washington, DC
SUMMIT: October 26–27
TRAINING: October 28–November 2

ICS Security
Orlando, FL
SUMMIT: June 7–9
TRAINING: June 10–15

For more info on upcoming Summit events, visit: sans.org/summits

SANS